

State and Territorial Archive Data Aggregation Planning Project

Recommendations Report

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Executive Summary



Executive Summary

By ensuring the quality and reliability of member data, CoSA not only bolsters its credibility but also enhances the trust placed in and by its members. This trust is pivotal in increasing CoSA's capacity to advocate for and secure federal funding on behalf of state and territorial archives.

In today's data-driven environment, the need for CoSA to enhance its management of member data is essential. Improving how data is collected, managed, and made accessible will streamline CoSA's operations and enhance decision-making processes. More critically, it will make data more accessible and actionable and lower the bar for data collection for state and territorial archives, who rely on accurate and timely data to optimize their operational effectiveness and strategic planning. This strategic enhancement of data management practices will establish CoSA as a leader among 21st-century membership organizations.

However, it is important to recognize that while these improvements will significantly enhance the quality of data, not all data will be immediately ready for advanced analytics. Sophisticated data visualizations and the full utilization of refined datasets may still require strong manipulation skills and the use of external tools like Tableau Public. Nonetheless, taking this initial step towards better data governance, sharing, and usage will propel the entire field of state and territorial archives forward, creating a foundational source of truth that benefits all members.

This report outlines actionable steps for CoSA to assert itself as a national leader in data management and a responsible caretaker of their community's data. AVP presents six strategic recommendations to advance this initiative. A high-level summary of these recommendations, which are designed to improve membership support and standardize data practices, is detailed on the following page. This focus will enable CoSA to provide robust support to its members, allowing them to access – and make accessible – essential information swiftly and efficiently, thereby providing the most support possible to its state and territorial archives members.

The recommendations on the following page are based on AVP's understanding of CoSA's current state, the research and exploration that is a result of our partnership, and the [Technical & Operational Framework](#).

The recommendations are presented with a [roadmap](#) for implementation, which focuses on the next 2.5 years. It is anticipated that work would begin in the third quarter of 2024.

Recommendations Overview

The recommendations outlined below and detailed further on the following pages, are derived from the insights gathered and progress made in collaboration with the CoSA project team since the project's inception in January 2024. We present six high-level recommendations, each accompanied by some number of sub-recommendations that provide guidance on implementation. Additionally, following the recommendations is a roadmap to specify and guide the timing for implementing these recommendations.

Adopt an Association Management System (AMS)

Create a single source of truth for CoSA membership data, including contact information and survey data responses.

Bring ARM survey data into the AMS

Enhance the usefulness of all CoSA data by associating survey and other relevant data with each member organization's profile in the AMS.

Develop an interactive dashboard for members

Provide members with actionable insights into CoSA data and customizable visualizations to help members advocate for resources.

Migrate resources to a new repository

Identify and implement an asset repository to store, manage, and share resources of value to the CoSA community.

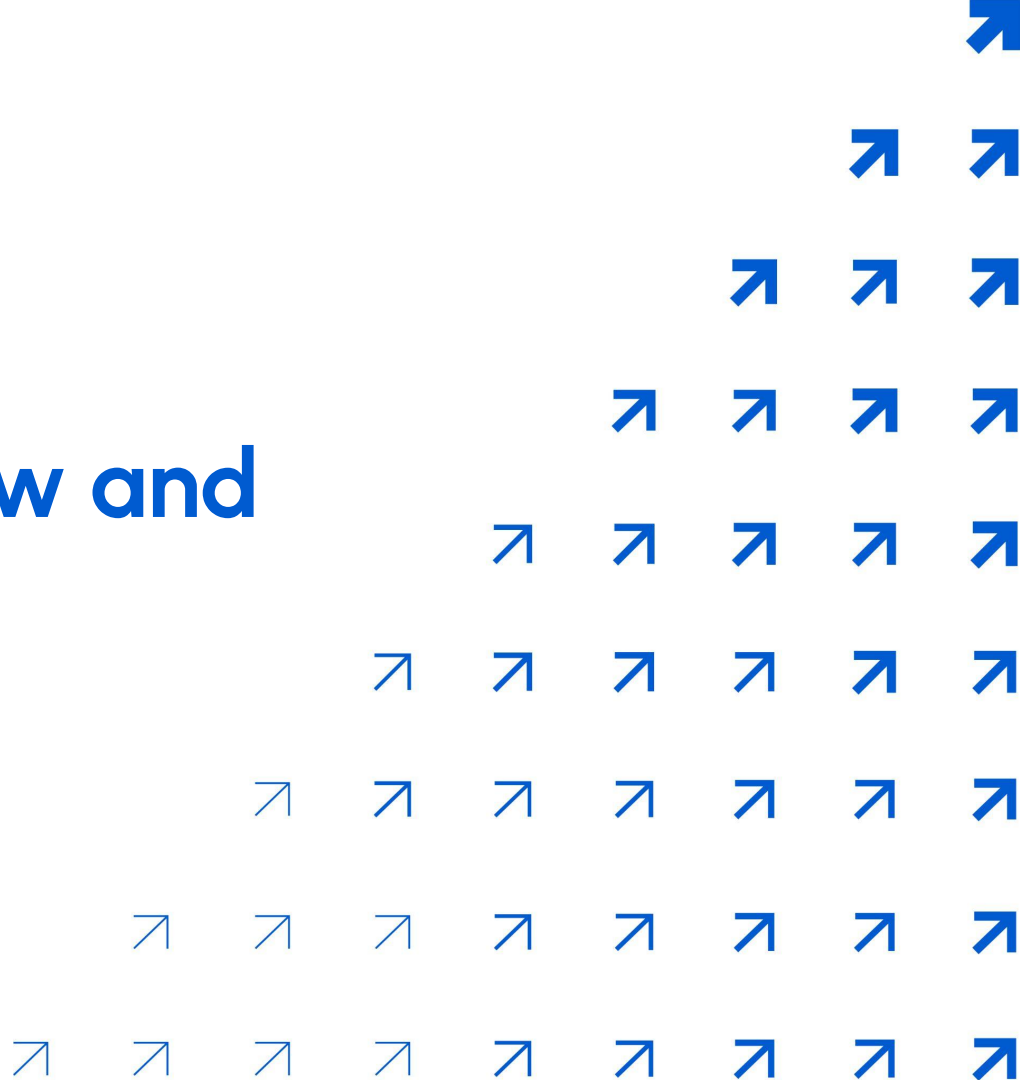
Make CoSA data accessible for download

Curate, normalize, and contextualize CoSA survey and other relevant data for tiered access in the CoSA repository and external data portals.

Streamline survey and data collection methods

Review and revise the survey process and questions to ensure the data CoSA collects is impactful and up-to-date.

Project Overview and Findings



Overview & Methodology

Background

The Council of State Archivists (CoSA) provides leadership to state and territorial archives through coordinating advocacy efforts; emergency preparedness training and electronic records management and digital preservation programming; and conducting and publishing research. The 56 state and territorial government archives have participated in regular data gathering activities since the 1980s through a variety of collecting mechanisms with CoSA assuming surveying responsibilities in the early 2000s. While the synthesis of these efforts are available from the CoSA website in the form of reports, the raw data, is not readily accessible. Given higher visibility and usability, this data could serve as a dynamic source of information for historical research, civic learning, and more effective advocacy for government archives and records management, particularly in combination with external datasets, such as census data and other government statistics.

Problem Statement

In the spring of 2024, CoSA engaged AVP to perform an assessment and provide recommendations to answer the question:

How might CoSA further the stewardship, access, and use of data from state and territorial archives by pooling together disparate internal and external data sets into a cohesive and easy to use data repository that meets internal and external user needs?

Methodology

AVP conducted the following activities to develop a plan for enhancing the value of CoSA's rich data.

→ Understand User Needs

AVP conducted discovery interviews and workshops with CoSA staff, members, and other stakeholders.

Learn more about discovery findings ([Slide 8](#))

→ Inventory Data

AVP worked with CoSA staff to identify the range of data content and formats collected over CoSA's history.

Learn more about CoSA's datasets ([Slide 10](#))

→ Proof of Concept

AVP selected two use cases and related datasets and prototyped a data visualization to understand the complexities of process from end to end.

Learn more about the proof of concept ([Slide 11](#))

→ Identify Data Platforms

AVP compiled functional requirements gathered during discovery and identified candidate systems for storing data and/or making data accessible.

Review the requirements and candidate shortlist ([Appendix A](#))

→ Develop an Action Plan

AVP drafted recommendations for CoSA to take immediate action and make longer-term plans toward enriching the value of CoSA's data.

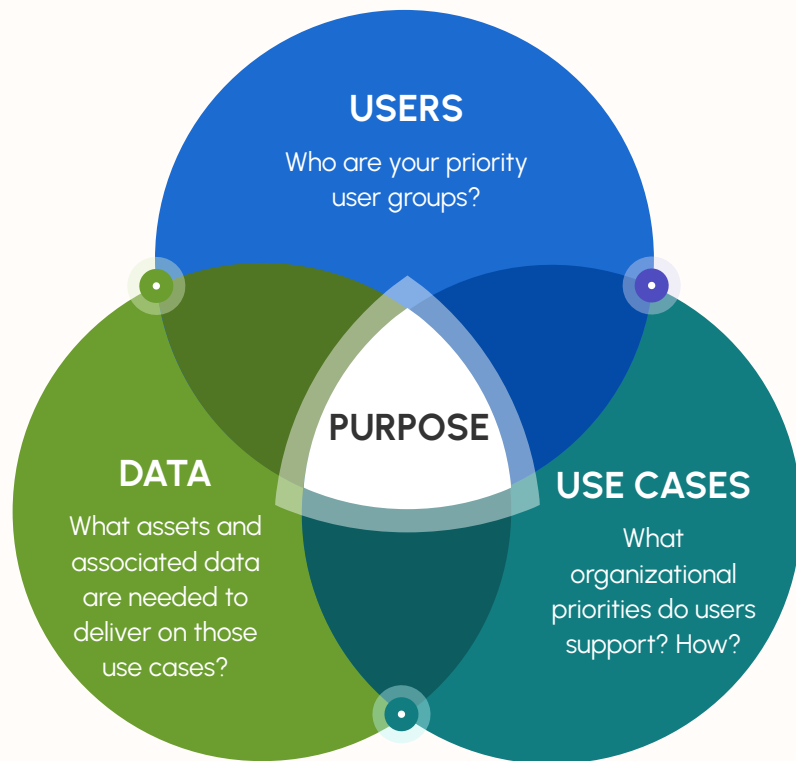
Learn more about the recommendations ([Recommendations](#))

Technical & Operational Framework

This framework highlights the key components crucial for the data management program that CoSA is undertaking. When these operational elements are effectively integrated and centered around a guiding purpose, they create a robust model that will deliver significant value to CoSA staff and members. Additionally, consistent application of this framework as new people, technologies, and processes join the CoSA ecosystem will enhance the benefits that members derive from engaging in CoSA surveys, events, and other activities.



Discovery Findings – Purpose



What is a Guiding Purpose?

The guiding purpose for a data strategy connects data to business value by identifying who your data serves, what outcomes they enable, and what data is required to achieve those outcomes. Identifying these areas helps establish focus, facilitates prioritization, and creates alignment amongst team members on what value delivery means and what success looks like. A guiding purpose should provide clear answers to three key questions:

- **Who are our primary data users (internally and externally)?**
- **What use cases do our data enable or support, and how?**
- **What data is needed to support those use cases?**

Discovery Process

AVP interviewed CoSA staff and volunteers to better understand the target audiences for their data and the data they have to offer, as well as CoSA's current system infrastructure, needs, and constraints. With these findings, AVP then conducted two two-hour workshops with 16 potential users of CoSA data representing CoSA staff, archivists, researchers, archives consultants, and funders to identify use cases and requirements for the data.

Discovery Findings – Users & Use Cases

During the discovery process, AVP surfaced a wide variety of use cases from the interviews and workshops and grouped them into broad categories. Below are examples of use cases from each category:



Users

Key users of CoSA data include, but are not limited to:

- CoSA member archives leadership
- CoSA member archivists
- CoSA staff
- Other archivists
- Individual researchers
- Granting agencies and other funders



Use Cases

Advocacy

A state archivist needs to compare their collection's size and scope to other state archives, so they can prepare marketing materials to advocate for more resources.

Electronic Records

An electronic records archivist needs to make a case for more IT support, so they can provide access to digital records from their state's agencies.

Staff Training & Growth

A state archivist needs to secure funding for staff professional development, so they can better serve their constituents' evolving needs.

Education/Comms

The communications specialist for a state archive needs to develop a report showing the archive's alignment with national trends.

Digital Preservation

A consultant to a state archive needs to see similar states budget for their digital storage, so they can help draft a roadmap for a digital preservation program.

Disaster Preparedness

A consultant to a state archive needs to demonstrate the importance of disaster planning to staff, so they will feel more invested in participating in the process.

Budget/Funding

A state archivist needs to make a case for increased budget funding by showing how their budget compares to similar states.

Collections

A state archivist needs to know how their collection size and scope compares to other states, so they can advocate for the appropriate staffing.

Discovery Findings – Data Sources

System	Data Source	Note
Airtable	- Membership data - Some ARM survey data	<i>Used to manage and organize member data and guide governance. Additionally, links survey categories to administrative units.</i>
CoSA Archives	- Surveys as early as the 1990s in paper - Early surveys in electronic form	<i>The archival collection houses historic surveys in various formats.</i>
HigherLogic	- Resource Library - Membership data	<i>Contains links to resource collection as well as basic membership data to run the website.</i>
Informatics	- Digital Preservation Capability Maturity Model survey (2022, 2024) - Some older survey data	<i>Expecting to sunset.</i>
Sogolytics	- State of the State survey - Archives and Records Management (ARM) survey (2022, 2020, 2018) - Records Management-only survey - PREPARE survey	<i>Contains the majority of the recent survey data collected by CoSA.</i>
SurveyMonkey	- Digital Preservation Capability Maturity Model survey (pre-2022) - COVID survey - Other small, basic surveys	<i>Originally used for long surveys; houses more complex surveys like DPCMM and some simpler, smaller surveys.</i>

Proof of Concept Findings

AVP developed proofs of concept for two use cases proposed by CoSA to illustrate the challenges involved in building compelling arguments with data, from dataset identification to data visualization. These proofs of concept also helped to assess the level and types of data support CoSA might provide members and other users. [Tableau Public](#), a free public version of the Tableau data visualization software, was used to generate interactive prototypes for these use cases.

Data sources

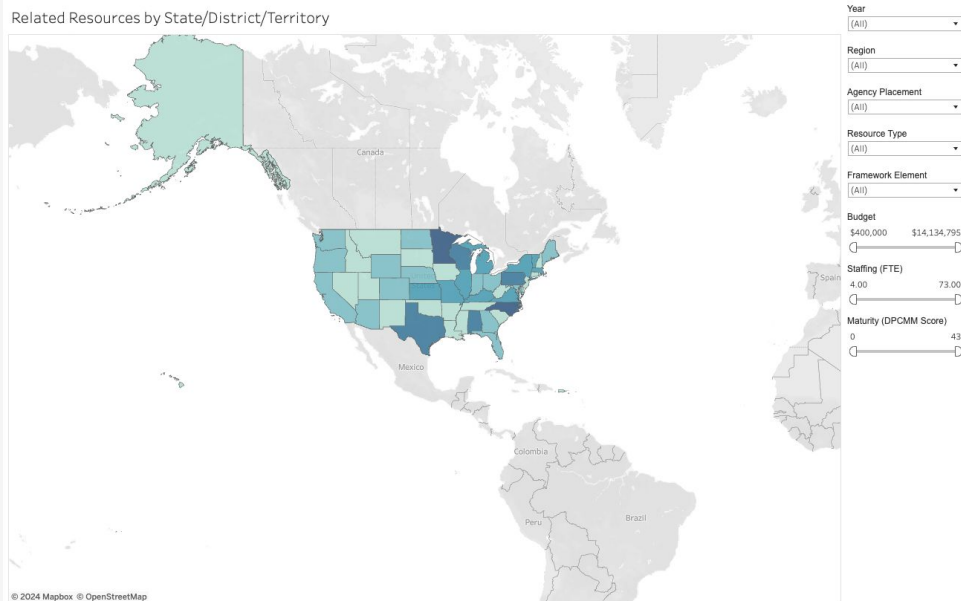
For both use cases, AVP created a master data set of states, districts, and territories, their regions, program types, agency placements, and several other data points, such as current budget, staffing (FTE), and DPCMM scores. Much of this data is available through the ARM survey and the DPCMM survey. For states that did not complete the ARM survey, the region, program type, and agency placement data was supplied from CoSA's internal airtable.

Use Case 1

CoSA supplied a spreadsheet of Resource Center records including metadata they had compiled related to the DPC Access Framework and tagged with related States, where applicable.

Use Case 2

AVP downloaded and reshaped [2020 population data](#) and [2022 state expenditures data](#) from the U.S. Census Bureau website.



Use Case 1: Resources by State

"An archivist needs to write a new digital preservation policy and is looking for states with a similar budget, number of staff, and a higher DPCMM score that have written and shared policies."

In this interactive visualization, number of resources associated with states are represented on a choropleth map by color density. CoSA members can filter the map to see states that are similar in features such as agency placement, budget, and staffing and can filter resources by year and resource type.

View visualization on [Tableau Public](#)

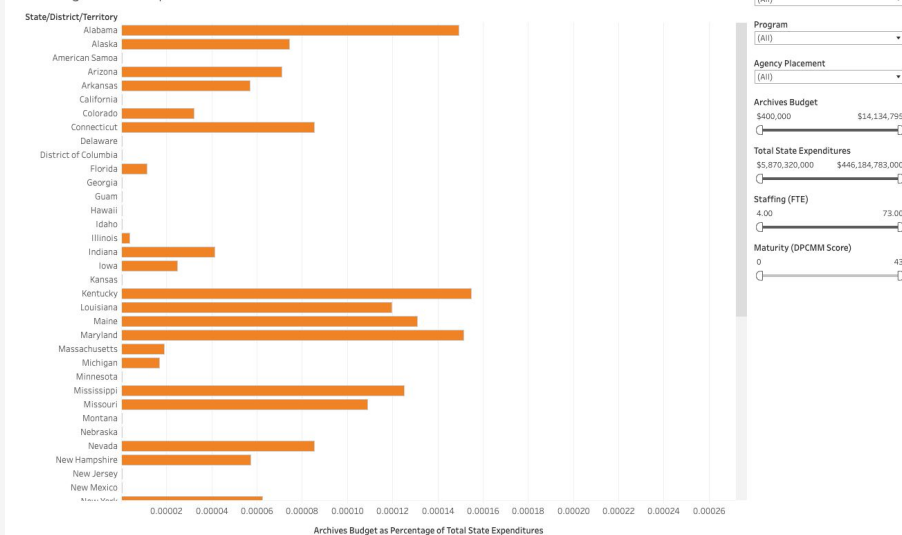
Proof of Concept Findings

Use Case 2: Expenditures and Population

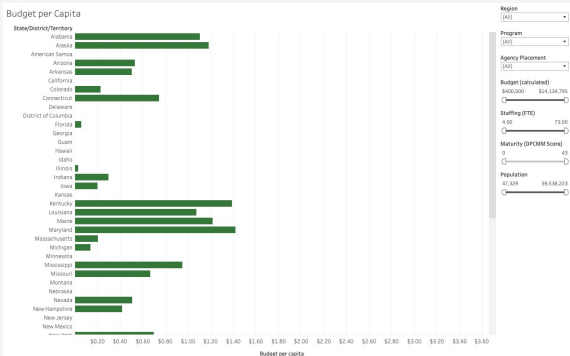
"A state archivist wants to make a case for a higher budget by comparing the percentage archives budget of total state budget and per capita budget of states with similar agency placement."

In these interactive visualizations, percentage archives budget of total state budget and per capita budget of states are presented as both bar charts and choropleth maps. CoSA members can filter the visualizations by features such as program, agency placement, budget, staffing, and DPCMM score to compare similar states.

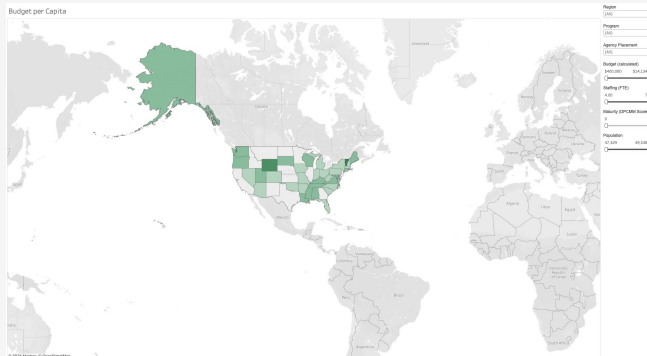
Percentage of Total Expenditures 2022



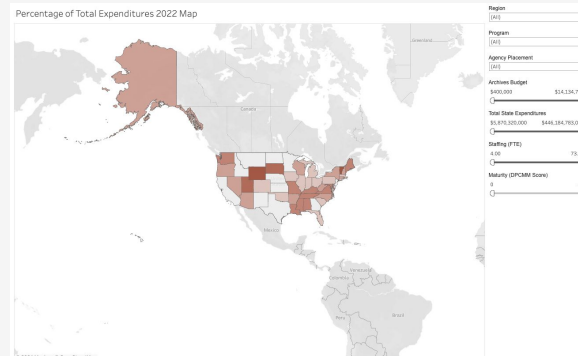
View visualization on [Tableau Public](#)



View visualization on [Tableau Public](#)



View visualization on [Tableau Public](#)



View visualization on [Tableau Public](#)

Proof of Concept Findings

Research Questions

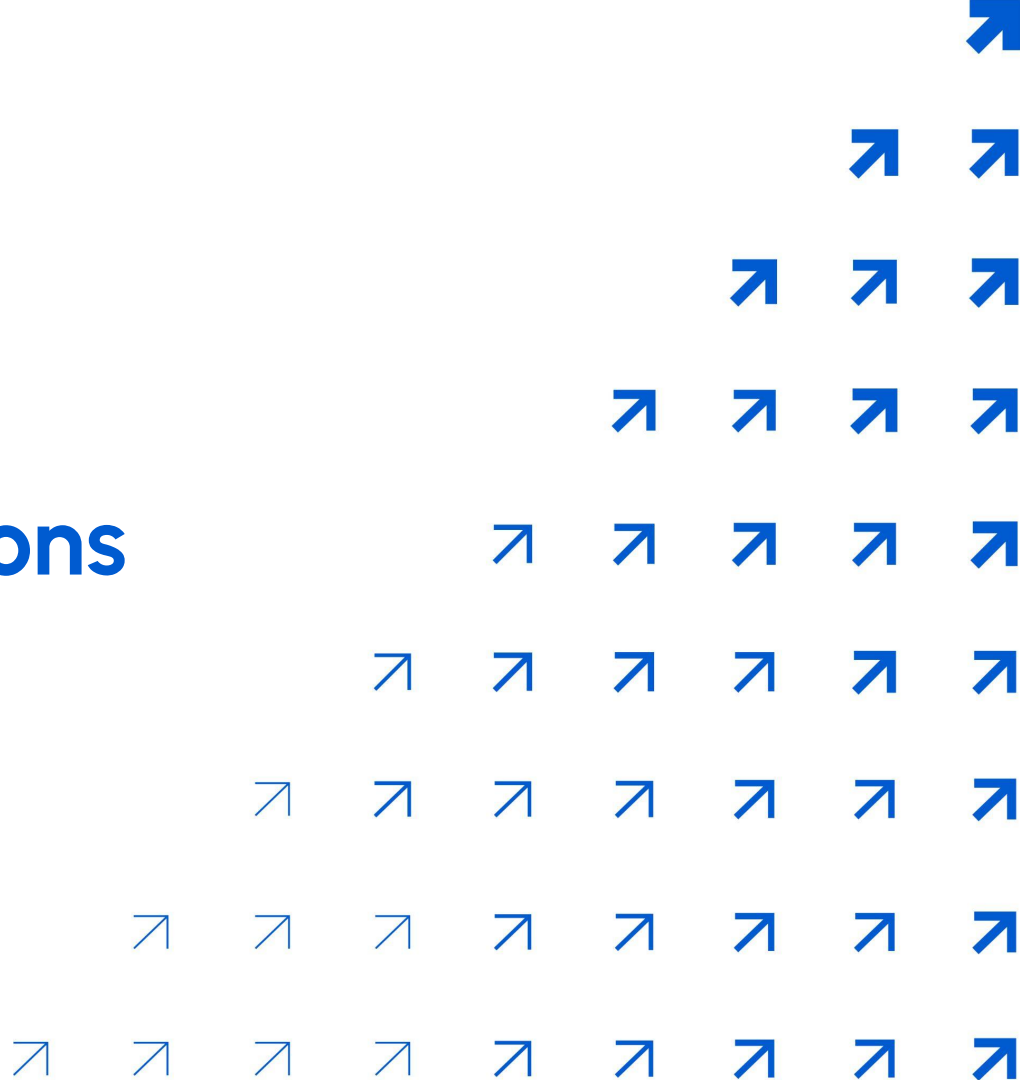
In planning and building the proof of concept, AVP and CoSA were interested in exploring the following questions and documenting our process as it relates to them. These insights aided in determining and prioritizing what immediate and long-term solutions CoSA should pursue.

- How did we decide what visualization would be effective?
- How did we find the right data for the visualization?
- What contextual information was necessary to understand the data and the visualization?
- How did we have to reshape or normalize the data for our purpose?
- What data was missing that we had to supply ourselves? How did we represent missing data that could not be filled in?
- How did our reshaping of the data potentially change how it may be interpreted?
- How difficult was it to combine different datasets? What are some of the dangers in combining datasets, either from CoSA or from external sources? How could the reshaping and/or joining of the data be misleading?
- What tools and skills were needed to create the visualization?
- What challenges came up in creating the visualization? How did we handle missing data? How could the visualization be misleading?
- What is gained from the visualized data that may be difficult to glean from the charts or tabular data in the CoSA report?
- How accessible is the visualization?

Key Findings

- CoSA will likely need to provide **cleaned versions of datasets** for users for data to be useful.
- Many data creation and data visualization tasks may prove too difficult for CoSA members with basic data manipulation skills. CoSA may wish to **prioritize providing interactive visualizations** for its members to use over preparing and publishing its data for download. Storing survey data alongside CoSA's member contact information may make this data more actionable for this purpose.
- **Contextual information** on data sources and missing data will be necessary to provide for accurate interpretation and visualization of data.
- For some use cases, the right visualization may help to **highlight gaps in the data**. However, some interactive features, such as filters, may hide these gaps and mislead users.

Recommendations



Recommendations Overview

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Adopt an Association Management System (AMS)

Create a single source of truth for CoSA membership data, including contact information and survey data responses.

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Enhance the usefulness of all CoSA data by associating survey and other relevant data with each member organization's profile in the AMS.

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Provide members with actionable insights into CoSA data and customizable visualizations to help members advocate for resources.

Migrate resources to a new repository

Identify and implement an asset repository to store, manage, and share resources of value to the CoSA community.

Make CoSA data accessible for download

Curate, normalize, and contextualize CoSA survey and other relevant data for tiered access in the CoSA repository and publication to external data portals.

Streamline survey and data collection methods

Review and revise the survey process and questions to ensure the data CoSA collects is impactful and up-to-date.

RECOMMENDATION

1

Adopt an Association Management System (AMS)

Create a single source of truth for CoSA membership data, including contact information and survey data responses.

AVP's findings indicate CoSA requires a robust solution to centralize the management of its membership data. Membership data includes not only basic contact information but also the valuable insights gathered through the ARM survey and others. Currently, this data is distributed across multiple platforms, including Higher Logic, Airtable, and various survey tools. Collocating this information in a single system is a critical step towards its effective long-term management and analysis. To do this, **AVP recommends CoSA adopt an Association Membership System (AMS).**

During AVP's engagement in May 2024, CoSA issued a Request for Information (RFI) to eight suppliers of Association Membership Systems (AMS) and one Customer Relationship Management (CRM) system. CoSA conducted four demonstrations in early June 2024 (for more information, see the [next slide](#)).

Given that the contract with CoSA's current web host (HigherLogic) will conclude in 2024, AVP strongly recommends the following actions:

- Finalize selection of the AMS by the end of June 2024.
- Begin contracting ASAP after selection is complete.
- Transfer HigherLogic web pages to AMS.

More detailed recommendations, in alignment with the Operational Model, can be found on the following pages.

RECOMMENDATION

1

Adopt an Association Management System (AMS)

Create a single source of truth for CoSA membership data, including contact information and survey data responses.

AMS	Overall score	Contact Name and Email	Meeting Date	Implementation cost	Annual cost	Note
ClubExpress	3.7/5	Steve Raftis	6/4/2024	~\$2,000	~\$1,500	Setup and monthly hosting fees include unlimited, toll-free support; most requirements supported
GrowthZone	4/5	Brennan Stout	6/11/2024	\$10,000-\$12,000	\$8,000 - \$10,000	Vast majority of requirements supported
HubSpot	4/5	Jurjen (JJ) de Vries	6/6/2024		\$10,008	Addresses most needs - very comprehensive. Great interface.
Keela						<i>Not a good fit - donor management</i>
MemberClicks	4.3/5	Carmen Zandkarimi	6/7/2024	\$3,750	\$6,000	Community component additional cost. No support for website migration. Modern interface.
NeonOne		n/a	n/a		n/a	<i>Vendor withdrew from competition</i>
Nimble AMS		n/a	n/a		n/a	<i>First year costs for NimbleAMS start at \$125K</i>
Wild Apricot		n/a	n/a		n/a	<i>Vendor withdrew from competition</i>
YourMembers hip		Not selected to move on to demo	n/a	\$3,035	\$5,400	API access is \$125/month; Website design is additional one-time cost.

RECOMMENDATION

1

Adopt an Association Management System (AMS)

Create a single source of truth for CoSA membership data, including contact information and survey data responses.

Recommendation 1: AMS Vendor Next Steps

AMS vendor demonstrations were conducted from June 1 to June 11. Following these demos, CoSA attendees completed an assessment survey for each vendor, with the scores detailed in the table on the [previous slide](#).

To select a new AMS vendor, CoSA should take the following steps:

1. Compile a final shortlist of 2-3 preferred vendors.
2. Arrange follow-up meetings with these shortlisted vendors to address any outstanding questions.
3. Request access to a pilot site from each vendor to evaluate the functionality hands-on.
4. Obtain updated quotes from each vendor, ensuring they reflect a complete understanding of CoSA's requirements and include a written agreement on the implementation timeline.
5. Choose the vendor that best meets CoSA's needs and ensure implementation is completed before the expiration of the HigherLogic contract.
6. Migrate current member data in HigherLogic and CMS content to new system.



ALIGNMENT WITH OPERATIONAL FRAMEWORK

The following recommendations are based on the operational framework in [this slide](#).

PEOPLE

- Hire a contractor to develop a data model for the new AMS that incorporates current membership contact information and survey data. This should be done once an AMS is selected and in partnership with the vendor/implementor.
- Obtain implementation support, either through the AMS vendor or a third-party contractor, to configure the system and web pages according to CoSA's requirements.

GOVERNANCE

- Establish a [data governance structure](#). We recommend the board take on the strategic role of setting broad data policies and goals in alignment with the organization's mission. Staff members can serve as both tactical and operational levels, handling the day-to-day management and execution of data tasks, such as implementing and managing the data model, surveying membership, and maintaining contact and membership data. Additionally, forming a small, rotating data governance committee from among the membership could prove beneficial. This committee would provide oversight and ensure diverse input in data-related decisions. Regular reviews and adjustments to this structure can help maintain its effectiveness as organizational needs evolve.

PROCESS

- Implementation of a new system involves careful planning. AVP recommends CoSA work with a contractor familiar with AMS implementations to develop and undertake an adoption methodology that ensures the process is efficient and effective for all users, with outcomes that directly address member needs.

RECOMMENDATION

1

Adopt an Association Management System (AMS)

Create a single source of truth for CoSA membership data, including contact information and survey data responses.

RECOMMENDATION

2

Bring ARM survey data into the AMS

Enhance the usefulness of all CoSA data by associating survey and other relevant data with each member organization's profile in the AMS.

AVP recommends CoSA merge ARM survey data and other rich member contact metadata for which CoSA is responsible to create a single member dataset managed in one purpose-built system. To that end, AVP recommends CoSA bring this disparate information together into the new AMS. The benefits of this approach are that it:

- Creates a comprehensive view of CoSA data.
- Centralizes all data together in one place, streamlining access and management.
- Leverages the AMS's analytics capabilities to gather meaningful insights from CoSA integrated data, driving informed decision-making.
- Empowers CoSA members to update their data independently, at their convenience. This ensures that data remains timely and accurate.
- Reduces data management overhead to allow the CoSA team to focus on strategic initiatives, improving overall productivity.

Together, this will enhance CoSA's data processes, improve member satisfaction, and optimize resource allocation. AVP suggests the following actions:

- Export data from HigherLogic. The data will likely require some manipulation and remediation before it can be migrated into the new system. **Be sure to work with the AMS vendor to ensure you are structuring your data correctly.**
- Migrate data into the AMS.

RECOMMENDATION

2

Bring ARM survey data into the AMS

Enhance the usefulness of all CoSA data by associating survey and other relevant data with each member organization's profile in the AMS.

ALIGNMENT WITH OPERATIONAL FRAMEWORK

The following recommendations are based on the operational framework in [this slide](#).



PEOPLE

- A data modeling contractor should also be able to migrate CoSA data into the new AMS. Utilizing professional services will help ensure the migration results in well-structured data that is correctly formatted and situated in the appropriate fields.

GOVERNANCE

- Establish a [data governance structure](#). [See [this slide](#) for more information]

CONTINUOUS IMPROVEMENT

- Once a system is chosen and the data has been merged, modeled, cleaned, and migrated to the newly configured AMS, it is crucial to conduct testing with a select group of potential users before a full rollout. This testing will help verify that the configurations and data structures are logical and functional. Based on feedback, make necessary adjustments. Regularly iterate on this process to continuously meet the evolving needs of the members.

RECOMMENDATION

3

Develop an interactive dashboard for members

Provide members with actionable insights into CoSA data and customizable visualizations to help members advocate for resources.

Insights from proof of concept development revealed that the end-to-end process of finding, interpreting, normalizing, reshaping, and visualizing data will require significant time and skills that many CoSA members may not be resourced to supply. Even if members have the resources to conduct their own analysis and visualizations, CoSA will still need to spend time providing context for their raw survey data to aid interpretability as well as clean the data to ensure it can be easily manipulated.

If one of CoSA's primary goals is to equip members with better planning and advocacy tools based in data analysis, doing this bulk of this work for the members will produce more immediately useful results. We recommend that CoSA **prioritize the development of an interactive dashboard** that leverages both CoSA's rich survey data and relevant external data sources to empower members to easily compare their archive along national trend lines and generate custom charts to use in their communications. A potential indirect benefit of this approach may be that it incentivizes less engaged members to volunteer more information for inclusion in the dashboard.

AVP suggests the following actions:

- Identify the most relevant or actionable data points about member institutions to include in the dashboard, ideally in collaboration with the CoSA advisory board or membership.
- Design and develop an online dashboard that can be embedded on the CoSA website, taking inspiration from similar dashboards such as the [IMLS Survey Comparison Tool](#).
- Normalize and reshape the relevant CoSA and external data needed for the dashboard, possibly in parallel with the AMS data integration activities detailed in Recommendation 2.
- Test and refine the dashboard functionality and content with CoSA membership.



ALIGNMENT WITH OPERATIONAL FRAMEWORK

The following recommendations are based on the operational framework in [this slide](#).

PEOPLE

- Consider hiring a contractor to assist with the design and development of the dashboard.
- CoSA staff will need to guide the purpose and scope of the dashboard.
- Consult with CoSA users to identify high impact, common use cases for analyzing and visualizing CoSA and external data.

TECHNOLOGY

- To minimize costs, consider using a freely available data visualization tool, such as [Tableau Public](#) or [Looker Studio](#) (formerly Google Data Studio).

GOVERNANCE

- Assign responsibility for oversight and development of the dashboard in the data governance structure detailed in Recommendation 1.

MEASUREMENT

- If possible, apply web analytics to the dashboard to measure use of the tool and/or downloads of data and charts.

CONTINUOUS IMPROVEMENT

- Test and refine the dashboard at regular intervals to ensure it is meeting the needs of CoSA members.

RECOMMENDATION

3

Develop an interactive dashboard for members

Provide members with actionable insights into CoSA data and customizable visualizations to help members advocate for resources.

RECOMMENDATION

4

Migrate resources to a new repository

Identify and implement a asset repository to store, manage, and share resources of value to the CoSA community.

To significantly enhance user interactions with CoSA resources, AVP strongly recommends investing in a purpose-built, hosted asset repository, such as DSpace (starting price \$3940/annually). Functional requirements that CoSA's current resource library lacks are fundamental features of an asset repository. These include:

- Comprehensive metadata storage and management capabilities
- Supports a wide range of structured metadata standards
- Full-text search capabilities
- Faceted browsing for intuitive navigation
- Customizable search filters
- Detailed statistics on item views, downloads, and user interactions
- Integration with tools like Google Analytics for advanced reporting
- Handles a variety of formats (documents, images, audio, video, source code, scripts, macros)
- Supports batch imports and exports
- Tailorable user interface to meet CoSA's specific needs
- Granular permission settings for different user roles
- Secure access to restricted or sensitive content
- Supports integration with other systems via APIs (e.g., the AMS)
- Facilitates hierarchical content structure



ALIGNMENT WITH OPERATIONAL FRAMEWORK

The following recommendations are based on the operational framework in [this slide](#).

PROCESS

- Work with HigherLogic to export a custom report of the Resource Center metadata and reconcile with existing updated spreadsheet data.
- Adopt a repository such as DSpace, migrate cleaned metadata to the system, and upload assets.

PEOPLE

- Refresh the resource library by engaging a contractor for a six-month period to research and identify relevant assets for inclusion in the resource library.

GOVERNANCE

- Similarly to the governance structure for membership data, the resource library also needs its own governance framework. This framework should address key questions such as: What types of resources should be collected? How can we ensure the resources stay relevant and up-to-date? Who determines the value of the resources? What steps should be taken when links become inactive? While the governance structure may mirror that of the membership data, it should likely involve different stakeholders.

RECOMMENDATION

4

Migrate resources to a new repository

Identify and implement a asset repository to store, manage, and share resources of value to the CoSA community.

RECOMMENDATION

5

Make CoSA data accessible for download

Curate, normalize, and contextualize CoSA survey and other relevant data for tiered access in the CoSA repository and publication to external data portals.

Once a new asset repository has been selected and assets have been migrated from HigherLogic, AVP recommends curating and packaging CoSA survey data and other relevant data for download. While the interactive dashboard will serve many common use cases, some CoSA members and other users will likely be interested in pursuing other types of analysis or visualization. Some of the ARM and DPCMM survey datasets have already been cleaned in Google Sheets and other tools, but additional context, such as the original survey instruments, data dictionaries, or descriptions of collection methods, will need to be included for users to understand the data and how to manipulate it. At a minimum, CoSA should include the (cleaned) raw survey datasets as supplemental files to their respective published reports, but creation of more focused data packages, such as longitudinal datasets of survey responses over time, may also be valuable to users. As stewards of the community's data, CoSA will also need to consider which audiences, members or the general public, may access each dataset.

External datasets, such as census or other governmental data, could also be considered for inclusion, if they are tailored and normalized to be easily joined with CoSA data. These additions could help bridge the gap in data manipulation skills needed to bring new insights from external sources into CoSA data.

In addition to CoSA's asset repository, datasets could also be shared through external data portals such as the [SAA Dataverse](#) to extend the reach of CoSA's advocacy efforts.

AVP suggests the following actions:

- Identify and prioritize CoSA datasets for inclusion in CoSA's asset repository.
- Develop guidelines and design patterns for normalizing CoSA data as user-friendly data products.
- Create data packages, including necessary contextual information, and upload to the asset repository and external data portals.
- Develop a data collection/access policy and strategy to guide future data acquisition and publishing activities.



ALIGNMENT WITH OPERATIONAL FRAMEWORK

The following recommendations are based on the operational framework in [this slide](#).

PEOPLE

- Engage the CoSA community in understanding the user needs, preferred formats, and appropriate levels of access to datasets.
- Consider hiring a contractor to assist with initial dataset guidelines, design, and creation.

GOVERNANCE

- Incorporate the development of a data collection/access policy and strategy into the repository governance framework detailed in Recommendation 1.
- Coordinate efforts between a Data Governance Committee and a new Issues and Standards Committee to map the impact of CoSA resources, activities, and data use to member organization improvements and identify opportunities for filling gaps in support.
- Develop and document guidelines for dataset design and normalization.

PROCESS

- Develop a systematized workflow for evaluating, normalizing, creating, and packaging datasets for inclusion in the asset repository.

MEASUREMENT

- If possible, apply analytics in the asset repository to track asset visits and downloads.
- Poll the CoSA membership at a determined frequency on dataset use to measure the impact of dataset publication activities and to gather feedback for improvement.

CONTINUOUS IMPROVEMENT

- Review member feedback and refine data formats and collection/access policy on an ongoing basis.

RECOMMENDATION

5

Make CoSA data accessible for download

Curate, normalize, and contextualize CoSA survey and other relevant data for tiered access in the CoSA repository and publication to external data portals.

RECOMMENDATION

6

Streamline survey and data collection methods

Review and revise the survey process and questions to ensure the data CoSA collects is impactful and up-to-date.

Discovery interviews and workshops with CoSA staff and members uncovered potentially valuable information that is not currently being collected by in survey activities. Additionally, CoSA staff noted a decreasing level of engagement from the membership in survey participation. The result of this increase in incomplete data and absence of relevant data points is that CoSA datasets begin to decline in usefulness. To fulfill its mission and retain its relevance in supporting members, CoSA should revisit their data scope and collection methods with a goal of encouraging greater participation among members in both data submission and data strategy.

Through the other member engagement activities suggested throughout the previous recommendations, CoSA can also learn more about what data points will be useful for members as well as their members' preferences for data submission methods and concerns about the broader visibility of their data. With this information, CoSA can begin to refine their data collection strategy to lower the bar to participation in data collection and better meet the needs of their members.

AVP suggests the following actions:

- Incorporate discovery questions around scope and survey participation into member engagement activities listed in previous recommendations, or conduct focus groups with members to address these topics specifically.
- Assess member concerns around data visibility and strategize new privacy methods, such as public access restrictions or anonymization of certain data points, that encourage member participation.
- Pilot alternative methods of collecting or updating member data, such as direct editing in the AMS or microsurveys, that will boost member participation.
- Update survey methods and questions based on discovery and pilot findings.



ALIGNMENT WITH OPERATIONAL FRAMEWORK

The following recommendations are based on the operational framework in [this slide](#).

PEOPLE

- Engage the CoSA community in learning what information is valuable to collect and what factors are preventing members from participating in data collection.

GOVERNANCE

- Within the context of the data governance structure, assign responsibility for discovery, assessment, strategy, and implementation of data collection improvements.
- Coordinate efforts between a Data Governance Committee and an Issues and Standards Committee to map the impact of CoSA resources, activities, and data use to member organization improvements and identify opportunities for filling gaps in support.

PROCESS

- Update survey or data collection methods and plan how to coordinate these efforts with biannual reports.

MEASUREMENT

- Track member participation rates as data collection practices are updated to ensure that any changes are appropriately addressing member concerns.
- Poll users and members on an ongoing basis about their satisfaction with data collection scope and practices.

CONTINUOUS IMPROVEMENT

- Review user and member feedback on an ongoing basis and update data collection methods and scope as necessary.

RECOMMENDATION

6

Streamline survey and data collection methods

Review and revise the survey process and questions to ensure the data CoSA collects is impactful and up-to-date.

Roadmap

KEY

Recommendation 1 Adopt an AMS

Recommendation 2 ARM survey data in AMS

Recommendation 3 Develop interactive dashboard

Recommendation 4 Migrate resources to new repository

Recommendation 5 Make CoSA data accessible for download

Recommendation 6 Streamline survey & data collection methods

Year 1/H2

Year 2/H1

Year 2/H2

Year 3+

1. Compile final shortlist
2. Hold follow-up meetings
3. Request access to a pilot site
4. Obtain updated quotes from each vendor
5. Choose vendor
6. Migrate current member data and CMS

Acquire and migrate to new resource library. Drive decision based on requirements in [this slide](#).

1. Identify relevant or actionable data points
2. Design and develop the online dashboard
3. Normalize and reshape the relevant CoSA and external data
4. Test and refine the dashboard functionality and content with CoSA membership

1. Perform ETL (Extract, Transform, Load) on survey data
2. Work with AMS vendor to ensure correct data structure
3. Migrate data into the AMS and merge with existing member contact data

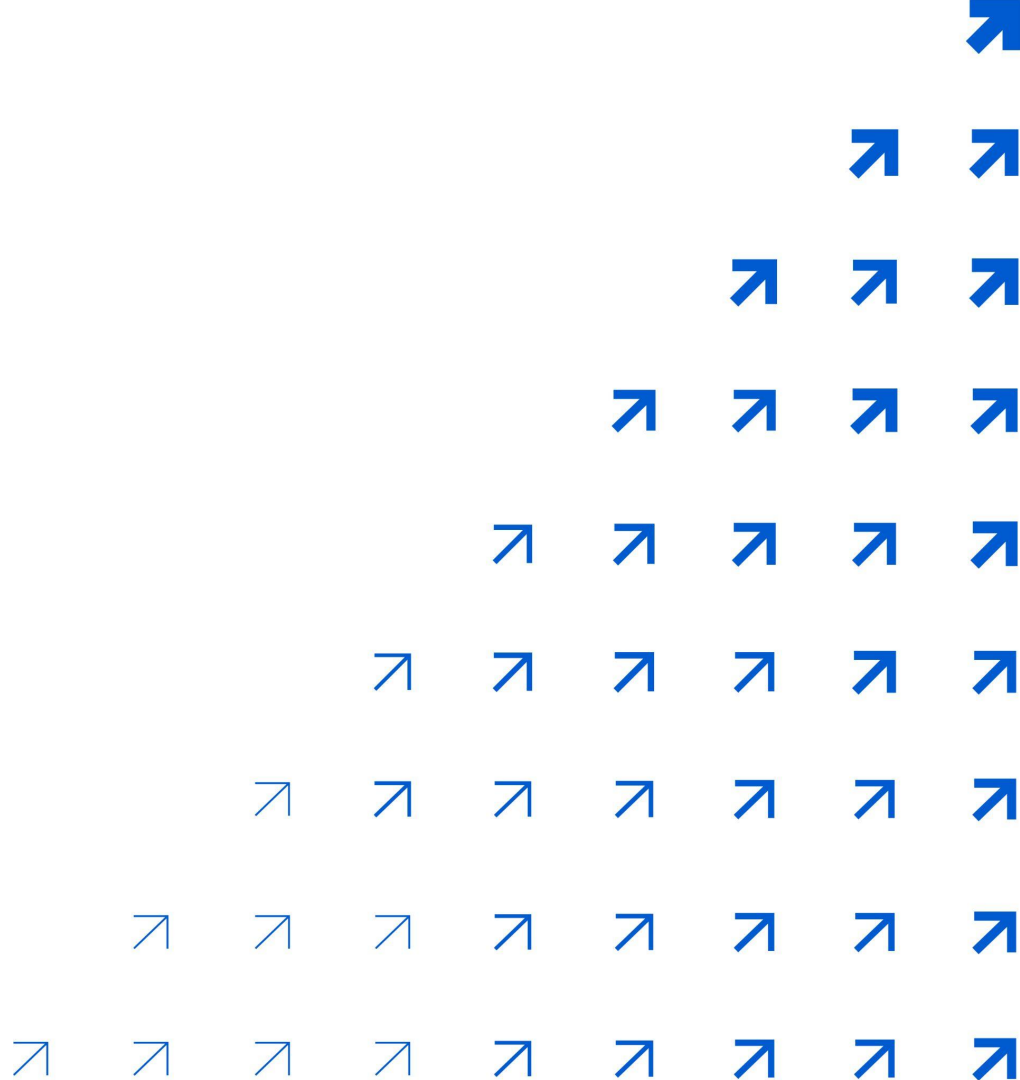
1. Identify and prioritize CoSA datasets for inclusion in CoSA's asset repository
2. Develop guidelines and design patterns
3. Create data packages and upload to CoSA and external repositories
4. Develop a data collection policy and strategy

1. Create data packages and upload to CoSA and external repositories

1. Conduct discovery around scope and survey participation
2. Assess member concerns around data visibility and strategize new privacy methods

1. Pilot alternative methods of collecting or updating member data
2. Update survey methods and questions based on discovery and pilot findings

Appendices



Appendices

[Appendix A. Requirements, Usage Scenarios, and Long List](#)

[Appendix B. Vendor Response to RFI - Summary](#)

[Appendix C. Proof of Concept Findings](#)